SSC MTS 2024 question paper with answers

15 October 2024 · Shift 1

79 questions as the Staff Selection Commission (SSC) printed them · answers from the official key · marking: 3 marks a question; no negative marking in Session-I (Numerical and Mathematical Ability, Reasoning), 1 mark deducted for each wrong answer in Session-II (General Awareness, English).

The other 11 of the paper's 90 questions are not reproduced: they need a figure or are printed as an image, or ask about formatting the source does not keep.

Try every question first: the answer key and the explanations follow the questions. Official answer-key notice: https://ssc.gov.in/api/attachment/uploads/masterData/AnswerKeys/approved_writeup_26425.pdf

Numerical and Mathematical Ability 14 questions

Q.2

A person sees another person snatching a chain from a lady, at a distance of 300 metres. He starts running and catches the thief by running at 10 km/h after running a total distance of 1.5 km. The speed at which the thief was running was:

(A) 8 km/h
(B) 9.5 km/h
(C) 9 km/h
(D) 8.5 km/h

Q.3

The greatest possible length of a scale that can exactly measure a cloth of lengths 250 cm, 420 cm and 710 cm is:

(A) 170 cm
(B) 10 cm
(C) 460 cm
(D) 71 cm

Q.4

The average age of 14 students and their teacher is 18 years. If the teacher's age is excluded, the average reduces by 1 year. What is the teacher's age?

(A) 32
(B) 35
(C) 37
(D) 34

Q.5

A wholesale dealer announced during the festival season that they are offering 'buy 4 shirts, get one free', then find the net discount percentage given by the dealer.

(A) 20%
(B) 10%
(C) 5%
(D) 15%

Q.6

An investment grows by 15% in the first month, 20% in the second month, and then decreases by 10% in the third month. If the initial investment was ₹5000, then the final amount (in ₹) is:

(A) 6,340
(B) 6,210
(C) 6,602
(D) 6,420

Q.7

A runner runs 300 metres race in 36 seconds. The runner’s speed in km/h is:

(A) 24
(B) 48
(C) 30
(D) 36

Q.9

Find the simple interest (in ₹) on ₹3000 as a sum borrowed at 8% per year rate of interest for 6 years.

(A) 1440
(B) 1400
(C) 1380
(D) 1480

Q.10

If the average marks of three batches of 40, 50 and 60 students, respectively, is 50, 60 and 75, then the average marks of all the students is:

(A) 70.00
(B) 63.33
(C) 65.50
(D) 61.25

Q.11

In an amusement park, all rides are equally priced, and the entry ticket for the park costs an additional ₹180. Rohan had 15 rides and paid a total of ₹1,380 for his visit to the park. How much (in ₹) in all would Rohan have to pay for his visit to the amusement park if he had opted for 20 rides?

(A) 1800
(B) 1760
(C) 1780
(D) 1840

Q.15

Vipul, Ashima, and Priya invested a total of ₹21,000 at 3%, 6%, and 5% per annum, respectively, on simple interest. If at the end of the year, all three persons received an equal amount of interest, then the amount (in ₹) invested by Ashima is:

(A) 3,000
(B) 4,000
(C) 5,000
(D) 2,000

Q.17

The cost price of 25 balls is the same as the selling price of 20 balls. Find the profit percentage.

(A) 15%
(B) 18%
(C) 25%
(D) 16.66%

Q.18

The batting average of a cricket player for 40 innings is 60 runs. His highest score in an innings exceeds his lowest score by 110 runs. If these two innings are excluded, the average score of the remaining 38 innings is 58 runs. Find his highest score.

(A) 153
(B) 220
(C) 310
(D) 290

Q.19

If the diagonal of a rectangle is 16 cm long and its perimeter is 48 cm long, find the area of the rectangle.

(A) 148 cm^2
(B) 120 cm^2
(C) 140 cm^2
(D) 160 cm^2

Q.20

Find the simple interest (in ₹) on ₹2000 as a sum borrowed at 7% per year rate of interest for 3 years.

(A) 380
(B) 420
(C) 360
(D) 460

Reasoning Ability and Problem Solving 16 questions

Q.1

4 is related to 32 following a certain logic. Following the same logic, 11 is related to 88. To which of the following is 6 related, following the same logic? (Note: Operations should be performed on the whole numbers, without breaking down the numbers into its constituent digits. E.g. 13 - Operations on 13 such as adding/subtracting/multiplying etc. to 13 can be performed. Breaking down 13 into 1 and 3 and then performing mathematical operations on 1 and 3 is not allowed.)

(A) 36
(B) 48
(C) 42
(D) 56

Q.2

VOJP is related to SLGM in a certain way based on the English alphabetical order. In the same way, XQLR is related to UNIO. To which of the following is ZSNT related following the same logic?

(A) WPKQ
(B) PWKQ
(C) WPQK
(D) PWQK

Q.3

Read the given statements and conclusions carefully. Assuming that the information given in the statements is true, even if it appears to be at variance with commonly known facts, decide which of the given conclusions logically follow(s) from the statements. Statements: No book is a copy. All stones are books. Conclusions: (I) No copy is a stone. (II) All books are stones.

(A) Both conclusions (I) and (II) follow
(B) Neither conclusion (I) nor (II) follows
(C) Only conclusion (II) follows
(D) Only conclusion (I) follows

Q.5

Seven people A, B, C, D, E, F and G are sitting around a circular table, facing the centre (but not necessarily in the same order). Only three people are sitting between C and G when counted from the right of C. E is sitting third to the left of G. Exactly one person is sitting between E and F when counted from the left of E. D is sitting to the immediate left of B. How many people are sitting between A and D when counted from the left of A?

(A) 4
(B) 2
(C) 1
(D) 3

Q.6

M, N, O, P, Q, R and S are sitting around a circular table facing the centre (but not necessarily in the same order). Q is an immediate neighbour of both R and P. M sits second to the left of R. O sits second to the left of M. S is not an immediate neighbour of O. The position of how many persons will remain unchanged if all persons are arranged in alphabetical order in a clockwise direction starting from 'M'?

(A) Six
(B) Four
(C) Seven
(D) Five

Q.7

What should come in place of the question mark (?) in the following series based on the English alphabetical order? YDY, WGT ,UJO ,SMJ, ?

(A) PPE
(B) QPE
(C) PPD
(D) PPF

Q.8

In a certain code language, 'MANAGE' is coded as 'IKEREQ' and 'RACE' is coded as 'IGEV'. What is the code for 'SYMPHONY' in the given code language?

(A) CRSLSQCW
(B) CRSLTQCW
(C) CRSLTRCW
(D) CRSLTPCW

Q.10

What should come in place of the question mark (?) in the given series? 647 614 581 548 515 ?

(A) 402
(B) 482
(C) 505
(D) 491

Q.11

Select the set in which the numbers are related in the same way as are the numbers of the following sets. (NOTE : Operations should be performed on the whole numbers, without breaking down the numbers into its constituent digits. E.g. 13 – Operations on 13 such as adding /deleting /multiplying etc. to 13 can be performed. Breaking down 13 into 1 and 3 and then performing mathematical operations on 1 and 3 is not allowed) (9, 63, 7) (27, 189, 21)

(A) (45, 310, 35)
(B) (45, 315, 35)
(C) (45, 315, 33)
(D) (40, 315, 35)

Q.12

Which two numbers should be interchanged to make the following equation correct? (15 ÷ 3)× 11 + 48 –21 × 2 + 8 = 57 (Note: Interchange should be done of the entire number and not individual digits of a given number.)

(A) 15 and 21
(B) 11 and 8
(C) 21 and 8
(D) 15 and 48

Q.13

In a code language, 'HWCY' is coded as ‘KBJH’ and 'REPU' is coded as ‘UJWD’. How will 'AXMQ' be coded in that language?

(A) CBSY
(B) DCTZ
(C) ECUZ
(D) DBTY

Q.16

What will come in place of the question mark (?) in the following equation, if ‘+’ and ‘–’ are interchanged and ‘×’ and ‘÷’ are interchanged? 18 ÷ 5 + 8 × 4 – 3 = ?

(A) 85
(B) 83
(C) 91
(D) 78

Q.17

In a certain code language, ‘DONE’ is coded as ‘7139’ and ‘TERM’ is coded as ‘6874’.What is the code for ‘E’ in the given code language?

(A) 9
(B) 6
(C) 7
(D) 8

Q.18

Read the given statement(s) and conclusions carefully. Assuming that the information given in the statements is true, even if it appears to be at variance with commonly known facts, decide which of the given conclusions logically follow(s) from the statement(s). Statements: Some branches are leaves. Some leaves are cables. Conclusions: (I) Atleast some cables are branches. (II) Some cables are leaves.

(A) Only conclusion (I) follows.
(B) Both conclusions (I) and (II) follow.
(C) Only conclusion (II) follows.
(D) Neither conclusion (I) nor (II) follows.

Q.19

In a certain code language, 'CAREER' is coded as ‘EBTFGS’ and 'CARING' is coded as ‘EBTJPH’. How will 'CENTER' be coded in the same language?

(A) DGOVFT
(B) EFPUGS
(C) EFPVGS
(D) DFPVFT

Q.20
FD7 is related to KI12 in a certain way. In the same way, PN18 is related to US23. To which of the following is AY21 related following the same logic?

(A) FD25
(B) HF25
(C) HF26
(D) FD26

General Awareness 25 questions

Q.1
The last Chalukyan King, defeated by the Rashtrakuta King Dantidurga, was _____.

(A) Vikramaditya I
(B) Kirtivarman II
(C) Vikramaditya II
(D) Pulakesin II

Q.2
A disease like COVID-19 is a kind of:

(A) Zoonotic disease
(B) Protein Deficiency disease
(C) Waterborne disease
(D) Foodborne disease

Q.3
Who among the following is the dance guru from Odisha credited with having revived the Odissi dance form?

(A) Birju Maharaj
(B) Sujata Mohapatra
(C) Vyjayanthimala
(D) Kelucharan Mohapatra

Q.4
As per Census 2011, which of the following states has the highest percentage of Buddhist population in India?

(A) Arunachal Pradesh
(B) Himachal Pradesh
(C) Sikkim
(D) Karnataka

Q.5
Which of the following harvest and cultural festivals is celebrated by the Tamil community every year in January?

(A) Makaravillakku
(B) Vishu
(C) Theyyam
(D) Pongal

Q.6
In 2023, which repository is proposed to be set up in a digital epigraphy museum, with digitisation of one lakh ancient inscriptions in the first stage?

(A) Progressive Repository of Indigenous Folklore
(B) Amrit Repository of Numismatic Collection
(C) Bharat Shared Repository of Inscriptions
(D) Indian Repository of Classical Coins

Q.7
In 1836, _____ became the Governor General of India.

(A) Lord Hastings
(B) Earl of Auckland
(C) Lord Curzon
(D) Robert Clive

Q.8
In which year was the first Senior Women's National Football Championship held in India?

(A) 2000
(B) 1995
(C) 1992
(D) 1950

Q.9
The GV Raja Memorial Trophy, Sir Ashutosh Mukherjee Trophy and Santosh Trophy are related to which of the following sports in India?

(A) Hockey
(B) Cricket
(C) Tennis
(D) Football

Q.10
In February 2023, who was appointed as the new Governor of Himachal Pradesh?

(A) Satyadev Narayan Arya
(B) Kalraj Mishra
(C) Bandaru Dattatreya
(D) Shiv Pratap Shukla

Q.11
The temperature of –273.15°C is called _____.

(A) standard temperature
(B) zero-point energy
(C) freezing point of water
(D) absolute zero temperature

Q.12
As per Article 163 of the Constitution of India, any advice tendered by Ministers to the _____ shall not be inquired into in any court.

(A) Governor
(B) President
(C) Chief Minister
(D) Chief Justice

Q.13
Who is properly known as the 'Grand Old Lady' of the Independence Movement?

(A) Aruna Asaf Ali
(B) Sarojini Naidu
(C) Madam Kama
(D) Usha Mehta

Q.14
Which of the following river valleys is NOT known for coal deposits in India?

(A) Mahanadi
(B) Satluj
(C) Godavari
(D) Son

Q.15
In which of the following cities was the first successful textile mill established in India in the year 1854?

(A) Bombay
(B) Bhopal
(C) Calcutta
(D) New Delhi

Q.16
The Directive Principles of State Policy are influenced by which of the following?

(A) Gandhian philosophy
(B) American declaration of independence
(C) Rule of Law of England
(D) French declaration of human rights

Q.17
The amount of dissolved oxygen in water becomes lowest at what time of the day?

(A) In the evening
(B) In the afternoon
(C) At night time
(D) In the dawn

Q.18
Chitti Babu is a famous player of which of the following musical instruments?

(A) Mridangam
(B) Veena
(C) Nadaswaran
(D) Sarangi

Q.19
Which of the following awards was conferred upon the Chhau dancer Siba Prasad Das in 2022?

(A) Sangeet Natak Akademi Fellowship
(B) Ustad Bismillah Khan Yuva Puraskar
(C) Padma Shri
(D) Sangeet Natak Akademi Amrit Award

Q.20
Which of the following microfinance units were established in India at the time of independence?

(A) Self Help Groups
(B) Grameen Model Banks
(C) Rural Cooperatives
(D) Joint Liability Groups

Q.21
The Early Vedic economy was primarily based on_____ activity.

(A) pastoral
(B) agricultural
(C) Mining Iron ore
(D) trading

Q.22
Select the correct combination of famous palaces and their locations in Rajasthan.

(A) Umaid Bhawan Palace – Udaipur
(B) Lalgarh Palace - Bikaner
(C) Rambagh Palace – Jodhpur
(D) Taj Lake Palace – Jaipur

Q.23
Who is the author of the novel 'Life and Death of Sambhaji' published in the year 2021?

(A) Rita Banerji
(B) Medha Deshmukh Bhaskaran
(C) Chitra Banerjee Divakaruni
(D) Amish Tripathi

Q.24
What does Age Structure represent?

(A) The number of females per 100 males in a given area at a specified time period
(B) The proportion of persons in different age groups relative to the total population
(C) The number of females per 1000 males in a given area at a specified time period
(D) A measure comparing the portion of a population composed of dependents with the portion that is in the working age group

Q.25
The percentage of sunlight energy absorbed by the green plants in a terrestrial ecosystem is about _____.

(A) 0.5%
(B) 1%
(C) 1.5%
(D) 2%

English Language and Comprehension 24 questions

Q.1
Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the underlined word in the given sentence. Although our new boss knew he was wrong, he was too "obstinate" to accept that.

(A) Flexible
(B) Competent
(C) Adamant
(D) Fearless

Q.2
Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the given word. Procrastination

(A) Timidness
(B) Hesitance
(C) Eagerness
(D) Hawing

Q.3

Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom. Like a bat out of hell

(A) Defeated
(B) In a bad situation
(C) Impossible
(D) Very fast and wildly

Q.4

In the following sentence the underlined part contains as error. Alternatives to the underlined part are given as options. Select the correct alternative. He is “truest” to his words.

(A) truly
(B) most truly
(C) truer
(D) true

Q.5

The following sentence has been divided into parts. One of them may contain an error. Select the part that contains the error from the given options. If you don’t find any error, mark ‘No error’ as your answer. This is the best novel / I have read, / in a very long time.

(A) No error
(B) I have read
(C) in a very long time
(D) This is the best novel

Q.6

Select the option that will improve the underlined part of the given sentence. Seizing the opportunity, Akhil decided to “take the bull with the horns”.

(A) take the bull at the horns
(B) take the bull on the horns
(C) take the bull by the horns
(D) take the bull in the horns

Q.7

In the following sentence the underlined part contains as error. Alternatives to the underlined part are given as options. Select the correct alternative. He was studying in the “dimmer” light.

(A) most dim
(B) dimmest
(C) more dim
(D) dim

Q.8

Select the most appropriate synonym of the underlined word. Her “austere” lifestyle reflected her minimalist approach to living.

(A) Luxurious
(B) Giddy
(C) Happy
(D) Sombre

Q.10

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. Please _____ with me for a while

(A) bear
(B) bairn
(C) bar
(D) bare

Q.11

The following sentence has been split into four segments. Identify the segment that contains a grammatical error. The sky is covering / with dark clouds and / I hope soon it / will begin to rain.

(A) The sky is covering
(B) will begin to rain
(C) I hope soon it
(D) with dark clouds and

Q.12

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the underlined word. You seem to be “mean” to your seniors.

(A) modest
(B) apathetic
(C) sympathetic
(D) rude

Q.13

Select the most appropriate option to substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. Heba “dropped of the club unexpectedly” to say hello and catch up.

(A) dropped by the club unexpectedly
(B) dropped between the club unexpectedly
(C) dropped besides the club unexpectedly
(D) dropped for the club unexpectedly

Q.14

Select the option that correctly rectifies the underlined spelling error in the given sentence. Women and children were often employed in the textile industry during the first “centuary” of industrialisation.

(A) century
(B) centuarie
(C) centuari
(D) centurie

Q.15

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. _____ we gave them was some homemade ice cream.

(A) While
(B) Which
(C) What
(D) When

Q.16

The given sentence is divided into three segments. Select the option that has the segment with a grammatical error. If there is no error, select ‘No error’. The committee has careful / considered the report which you sent us / and has decided to take action.

(A) considered the report which you sent us
(B) and has decided to take action.
(C) No error
(D) The committee has careful

Q.17

Select the option that rectifies the spelling error in the following sentence. In his persuit of excellence, he forgot to take care of his health.

(A) pursuite
(B) pursuit
(C) persuite
(D) persoot

Q.18

The following sentence has been divided into parts. One of them may contain an error. Select the part that contains the error from the given options. If you don’t find any error, mark ‘No error’ as your answer. Sam and Teena / had wondering / what to do this weekend.

(A) Sam and Teena
(B) had wondering
(C) what to do this weekend
(D) No error

Q.19

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. The rising interest in and concern about animal welfare resulted in legislative laws and the formation of The Animal _____ Committee in many nations.

(A) Considers
(B) Ethics
(C) Customs
(D) Resistant

Q.20

Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom. at top of your lungs

(A) pretend superiority
(B) exhausted
(C) extremely silly
(D) extremely loudly

Q.21

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Language is a powerful device that (1)_____ communication and interaction between individuals. It serves as a crucial tool for expressing thoughts, emotions, and ideas. (2)_____ richness of language can be observed in various forms, including spoken and written interaction. People employ language to convey their intentions, share knowledge, and build relationships. It is a fundamental aspect of human interaction and plays a vital role in shaping societies and cultures. Without language, cooperation would be (3)_____, as it serves as the foundation for collaboration and understanding among diverse communities. Furthermore, language is dynamic and stationary, evolving over time to adapt to changing environments. New words are (4)_____ into the vocabulary, reflecting advancements in technology, science and culture. The ability to modify and adapt language is a key aspect of linguistic competence. (5)_____, the importance of language cannot be underestimated. It is a fundamental tool for human expression and interaction, facilitating the exchange of ideas and the formation of connections among people.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 1.

(A) delays
(B) facilitates
(C) qualifies
(D) experiences

Q.22

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Language is a powerful device that (1)_____ communication and interaction between individuals. It serves as a crucial tool for expressing thoughts, emotions, and ideas. (2)_____ richness of language can be observed in various forms, including spoken and written interaction. People employ language to convey their intentions, share knowledge, and build relationships. It is a fundamental aspect of human interaction and plays a vital role in shaping societies and cultures. Without language, cooperation would be (3)_____, as it serves as the foundation for collaboration and understanding among diverse communities. Furthermore, language is dynamic and stationary, evolving over time to adapt to changing environments. New words are (4)_____ into the vocabulary, reflecting advancements in technology, science and culture. The ability to modify and adapt language is a key aspect of linguistic competence. (5)_____, the importance of language cannot be underestimated. It is a fundamental tool for human expression and interaction, facilitating the exchange of ideas and the formation of connections among people.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 2.

(A) A
(B) The
(C) No article
(D) An

Q.23

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Language is a powerful device that (1)_____ communication and interaction between individuals. It serves as a crucial tool for expressing thoughts, emotions, and ideas. (2)_____ richness of language can be observed in various forms, including spoken and written interaction. People employ language to convey their intentions, share knowledge, and build relationships. It is a fundamental aspect of human interaction and plays a vital role in shaping societies and cultures. Without language, cooperation would be (3)_____, as it serves as the foundation for collaboration and understanding among diverse communities. Furthermore, language is dynamic and stationary, evolving over time to adapt to changing environments. New words are (4)_____ into the vocabulary, reflecting advancements in technology, science and culture. The ability to modify and adapt language is a key aspect of linguistic competence. (5)_____, the importance of language cannot be underestimated. It is a fundamental tool for human expression and interaction, facilitating the exchange of ideas and the formation of connections among people.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 3.

(A) challenge
(B) challenging
(C) challenges
(D) challenger

Q.24

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Language is a powerful device that (1)_____ communication and interaction between individuals. It serves as a crucial tool for expressing thoughts, emotions, and ideas. (2)_____ richness of language can be observed in various forms, including spoken and written interaction. People employ language to convey their intentions, share knowledge, and build relationships. It is a fundamental aspect of human interaction and plays a vital role in shaping societies and cultures. Without language, cooperation would be (3)_____, as it serves as the foundation for collaboration and understanding among diverse communities. Furthermore, language is dynamic and stationary, evolving over time to adapt to changing environments. New words are (4)_____ into the vocabulary, reflecting advancements in technology, science and culture. The ability to modify and adapt language is a key aspect of linguistic competence. (5)_____, the importance of language cannot be underestimated. It is a fundamental tool for human expression and interaction, facilitating the exchange of ideas and the formation of connections among people.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 4.

(A) integrated
(B) integral
(C) integrity
(D) integration

Q.25

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Language is a powerful device that (1)_____ communication and interaction between individuals. It serves as a crucial tool for expressing thoughts, emotions, and ideas. (2)_____ richness of language can be observed in various forms, including spoken and written interaction. People employ language to convey their intentions, share knowledge, and build relationships. It is a fundamental aspect of human interaction and plays a vital role in shaping societies and cultures. Without language, cooperation would be (3)_____, as it serves as the foundation for collaboration and understanding among diverse communities. Furthermore, language is dynamic and stationary, evolving over time to adapt to changing environments. New words are (4)_____ into the vocabulary, reflecting advancements in technology, science and culture. The ability to modify and adapt language is a key aspect of linguistic competence. (5)_____, the importance of language cannot be underestimated. It is a fundamental tool for human expression and interaction, facilitating the exchange of ideas and the formation of connections among people.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 5.

(A) In order to

(B) In conclusive

(C) In spite of

(D) In any case

Answer key

Numerical and Mathematical Ability

Q.2 **(A)**	Q.3 **(B)**	Q.4 **(A)**	Q.5 **(A)**	Q.6 **(B)**	Q.7 **(C)**
Q.9 **(A)**	Q.10 **(B)**	Q.11 **(C)**	Q.15 **(C)**	Q.17 **(C)**	Q.18 **(A)**
Q.19 **(D)**	Q.20 **(B)**				

Reasoning Ability and Problem Solving

Q.1 **(B)**	Q.2 **(A)**	Q.3 **(D)**	Q.5 **(B)**	Q.6 **(C)**	Q.7 **(B)**
Q.8 **(B)**	Q.10 **(B)**	Q.11 **(B)**	Q.12 **(B)**	Q.13 **(B)**	Q.16 **(C)**
Q.17 **(C)**	Q.18 **(C)**	Q.19 **(B)**	Q.20 **(D)**		

General Awareness

Q.1 **(B)**	Q.2 **(A)**	Q.3 **(D)**	Q.4 **(C)**	Q.5 **(D)**	Q.6 **(C)**
Q.7 **(B)**	Q.8 **(C)**	Q.9 **(D)**	Q.10 **(D)**	Q.11 **(D)**	Q.12 **(A)**
Q.13 **(A)**	Q.14 **(B)**	Q.15 **(A)**	Q.16 **(A)**	Q.17 **(D)**	Q.18 **(B)**
Q.19 **(D)**	Q.20 **(C)**	Q.21 **(A)**	Q.22 **(B)**	Q.23 **(B)**	Q.24 **(B)**
Q.25 **(B)**					

English Language and Comprehension

Q.1 **(A)**	Q.2 **(C)**	Q.3 **(D)**	Q.4 **(D)**	Q.5 **(A)**	Q.6 **(C)**
Q.7 **(D)**	Q.8 **(D)**	Q.10 **(A)**	Q.11 **(A)**	Q.12 **(C)**	Q.13 **(A)**
Q.14 **(A)**	Q.15 **(C)**	Q.16 **(D)**	Q.17 **(B)**	Q.18 **(B)**	Q.19 **(B)**
Q.20 **(D)**	Q.21 **(B)**	Q.22 **(B)**	Q.23 **(B)**	Q.24 **(A)**	Q.25 **(D)**

Explanations

Numerical and Mathematical Ability

Q.2 · Answer (A) 8 km/h

While the man runs 1.5 km at 10 km/h (0.15 hours), the thief, 300 m ahead, runs 1.5 – 0.3 = 1.2 km. 1.2 ÷ 0.15 = 8 km/h.

Q.3 · Answer (B) 10 cm

The longest scale is the HCF of the lengths: $250 = 2 \times 5^3$, $420 = 2^2 \times 3 \times 5 \times 7$ and $710 = 2 \times 5 \times 71$, so the HCF is $2 \times 5 = 10$ cm.

Q.4 · Answer (A) 32

All 15 together total $15 \times 18 = 270$ years and the 14 students $14 \times 17 = 238$ years. The teacher is $270 - 238 = 32$.

Q.5 · Answer (A) 20%

The buyer gets 5 shirts for the price of 4, so 1 shirt in 5 is free: a discount of 1/5 = 20%.

Q.6 · Answer (B) 6,210

₹5,000 × 1.15 × 1.2 × 0.9 = ₹6,210.

Q.7 · Answer (C) 30

300 m in 36 s is 300/36 = 25/3 m/s, and 25/3 × 18/5 = 30 km/h.

Q.9 · Answer (A) 1440

SI = 3,000 × 8 × 6/100 = ₹1,440.

Q.10 · Answer (B) 63.33

Total marks = 40 × 50 + 50 × 60 + 60 × 75 = 2,000 + 3,000 + 4,500 = 9,500 for 150 students: 9,500/150 = 63.33.

Q.11 · Answer (C) 1780

Without the ₹180 entry ticket, 15 rides cost ₹1,200, so ₹80 a ride. With 20 rides: 20 × 80 + 180 = ₹1,780.

Q.15 · Answer (C) 5,000

If each earns interest I, the sums are I/0.03 + I/0.06 + I/0.05 = 70I = 21,000, so I = ₹300. Ashima's sum = 300/0.06 = ₹5,000.

Q.17 · Answer (C) 25%

The selling price of 20 balls buys 25, so the profit on 20 balls is the cost of 5: 5/20 × 100 = 25%.

Q.18 · Answer (A) 153

The 40 innings total 40 × 60 = 2,400 and the other 38 total 38 × 58 = 2,204, so highest + lowest = 196. With highest – lowest = 110, the highest is (196 + 110)/2 = 153.

Q.19 · Answer (D) 160 cm²

SSC's key gives 160 cm², from the usual working: $l + b = 24$ and $l^2 + b^2 = 16^2 = 256$, so $2lb = 24^2 - 256 = 320$ and $lb = 160$. Strictly, no rectangle has these measurements: a 16 cm diagonal allows a perimeter of at most $32\sqrt{2} \approx 45.3$ cm, and $(l - b)^2 = 256 - 320$ would be negative.

Q.20 · Answer (B) 420

SI = 2,000 × 7 × 3/100 = ₹420.

Reasoning Ability and Problem Solving

Q.1 · Answer (B) 48

Each number is multiplied by 8: 4 × 8 = 32 and 11 × 8 = 88. So 6 × 8 = 48.

Q.2 · Answer (A) WPKQ

Each letter moves 3 places back: V → S, O → L, J → G, P → M. So Z → W, S → P, N → K and T → Q: WPKQ.

Q.3 · Answer (D) Only conclusion (I) follows

No book is a copy and every stone is a book, so no stone is a copy and no copy is a stone (I). All stones are books, but not every book need be a stone, so II does not follow.

Q.5 · Answer (B) 2

G is fourth to the right of C, E third to the left of G and F second to the left of E, with C between them; D, immediately left of B, and A fill the other seats. Going left (clockwise) from C the order is C, F, A, G, B, D, E, so from A's left G and B sit before D: two people.

Q.6 · Answer (C) Seven

M is second to the left of R and O second to the left of M. Q cannot sit on R's left (P would need M's seat), so Q is on R's right with P beyond it; S, not next to O, takes the seat on R's left, and N the seat between M and O. Clockwise the order is already M, N, O, P, Q, R, S, so all seven keep their places.

Q.7 · Answer (B) QPE

First letters go back 2 (Y, W, U, S, Q), second letters forward 3 (D, G, J, M, P) and third letters back 5 (Y, T, O, J, E): QPE.

Q.8 · Answer (B) CRSLTQCW

The word is reversed and each letter moved 4 places forward: MANAGE → EGANAM → IKEREQ and RACE → ECAR → IGEV. SYMPHONY → YNOHPMYS → CRSLTQCW.

Q.10 · Answer (B) 482

Each term is 33 less than the one before: 515 − 33 = 482.

Q.11 · Answer (B) (45, 315, 35)

The middle number is 7 times the first and 9 times the third: 9 × 7 = 63 = 7 × 9 and 27 × 7 = 189 = 21 × 9. Likewise 45 × 7 = 315 = 35 × 9.

Q.12 · Answer (B) 11 and 8

With 11 and 8 interchanged: (15 ÷ 3) × 8 + 48 − 21 × 2 + 11 = 40 + 48 − 42 + 11 = 57.

Q.13 · Answer (B) DCTZ

The letters move forward 3, 5, 7 and 9 places, wrapping round after Z: HWCY → KBJH and REPU → UJWD. So AXMQ → DCTZ.

Q.16 · Answer (C) 91

After interchanging the signs: 18 × 5 − 8 ÷ 4 + 3 = 90 − 2 + 3 = 91.

Q.17 · Answer (C) 7

E is the only letter in both words and 7 the only digit in both codes, so E = 7.

Q.18 · Answer (C) Only conclusion (II) follows.

Some leaves are cables, so some cables are leaves (II). Branches and cables are linked only through leaves, which may be different ones, so I does not follow.

Q.19 · Answer (B) EFPUGS

The letters move forward 2 and 1 places alternately: CAREER → EBTFGS and CARING → EBTJPH. So CENTER → EFPUGS.

Q.20 · Answer (D) FD26

Each letter moves 5 places forward (Y wraps round to D) and the number rises by 5: FD7 → KI12 and PN18 → US23. So AY21 → FD26.

General Awareness

Q.1 · Answer (B) Kirtivarman II

Dantidurga overthrew Kirtivarman II, the last Chalukya king of Badami, in the mid-eighth century and founded the Rashtrakuta empire.

Q.2 · Answer (A) Zoonotic disease
COVID-19 is caused by a coronavirus believed to have passed to humans from animals, which makes it a zoonotic disease.

Q.3 · Answer (D) Kelucharan Mohapatra
Guru Kelucharan Mohapatra led the twentieth-century revival of Odissi. Birju Maharaj was a Kathak master.

Q.4 · Answer (C) Sikkim
In the 2011 census Buddhists were about 27% of Sikkim's population, the highest share of any state.

Q.5 · Answer (D) Pongal
Pongal, the Tamil harvest festival, falls in mid-January at the start of the Tamil month of Thai. Vishu is Kerala's new year and Theyyam a ritual dance of Kerala.

Q.6 · Answer (C) Bharat Shared Repository of Inscriptions
The Union Budget 2023-24 announced a 'Bharat Shared Repository of Inscriptions' in a digital epigraphy museum, with one lakh ancient inscriptions digitised in the first stage.

Q.7 · Answer (B) Earl of Auckland
George Eden, Lord Auckland (later Earl of Auckland), was Governor-General from 1836 to 1842; the First Anglo-Afghan War began during his term.

Q.8 · Answer (C) 1992
By the All India Football Federation's account, the first edition of the championship was held in Manipur in 1992 (the 1991-92 season).

Q.9 · Answer (D) Football
The Santosh Trophy is India's national football championship for state teams; SSC's key places the GV Raja Memorial and Sir Ashutosh Mukherjee trophies in football as well.

Q.10 · Answer (D) Shiv Pratap Shukla
Shiv Pratap Shukla was appointed Governor of Himachal Pradesh in February 2023.

Q.11 · Answer (D) absolute zero temperature
–273.15 °C is 0 K, absolute zero, the lowest temperature possible.

Q.12 · Answer (A) Governor
Article 163(3): whether, and what, advice was tendered by Ministers to the Governor shall not be inquired into in any court. Article 74(2) says the same of advice to the President.

Q.13 · Answer (A) Aruna Asaf Ali
Aruna Asaf Ali, who hoisted the Congress flag at Gowalia Tank in Bombay at the start of the Quit India Movement in 1942, is remembered as the 'Grand Old Lady' of the Independence Movement.

Q.14 · Answer (B) Satluj
India's Gondwana coal lies in the valleys of the Damodar, Son, Mahanadi, Godavari and Wardha; the Satluj valley has no coal deposits of note.

Q.15 · Answer (A) Bombay
C. N. Davar's Bombay Spinning and Weaving Company, started in Bombay in 1854, was India's first successful cotton textile mill.

Q.16 · Answer (A) Gandhian philosophy
Several Directive Principles carry Gandhian ideals: village panchayats (Article 40), cottage industries (Article 43), prohibition (Article 47) and cow protection (Article 48). The idea of Directive Principles itself came from the Irish Constitution.

Q.17 · Answer (D) In the dawn
Through the night plants and animals in the water use up oxygen in respiration with no photosynthesis to replace it, so dissolved oxygen is lowest around dawn.

Q.18 · Answer (B) Veena
Chitti Babu was a celebrated Carnatic veena player.

Q.19 · Answer (D) Sangeet Natak Akademi Amrit Award
Siba Prasad Das, a Chhau dancer from Odisha, was among the artists named for the Sangeet Natak Akademi Amrit Award in 2022, a one-time honour for artists over 75 who had received no national honour.

Q.20 · Answer (C) Rural Cooperatives
Rural cooperative credit societies date back to the Co-operative Credit Societies Act of 1904. Self Help Groups (linked to banks from 1992), Grameen-model banks and Joint Liability Groups all came later.

Q.21 · Answer (A) pastoral
The Rig Vedic people were mainly pastoral, with cattle as their chief wealth; agriculture became the mainstay in the Later Vedic period.

Q.22 · Answer (B) Lalgarh Palace - Bikaner
Lalgarh Palace is in Bikaner. Umaid Bhawan Palace is in Jodhpur, Rambagh Palace in Jaipur and the Taj Lake Palace in Udaipur.

Q.23 · Answer (B) Medha Deshmukh Bhaskaran
'Life and Death of Sambhaji' (Ebury Press, 2021) is by Medha Deshmukh Bhaskaran.

Q.24 · Answer (B) The proportion of persons in different age groups relative to the total population
Age structure is the share of people in each age group of a population. The other options describe sex ratios and the dependency ratio.

Q.25 · Answer (B) 1%
Green plants in a terrestrial ecosystem capture only about 1% of the sunlight falling on their leaves and convert it into food energy.

English Language and Comprehension

Q.1 · Answer (A) Flexible
'Obstinate' means stubbornly refusing to change one's mind; its opposite is 'flexible'. 'Adamant' is a synonym.

Q.2 · Answer (C) Eagerness
'Procrastination' is putting things off; its opposite is 'eagerness' to get on with them. 'Hesitance' and 'hawing' are close to synonyms.

Q.3 · Answer (D) Very fast and wildly
To go 'like a bat out of hell' is to go extremely fast and recklessly.

Q.4 · Answer (D) true
Nothing is being compared, so the positive degree: 'He is true to his words.'

Q.5 · Answer (A) No error
The sentence is correct: 'the best novel I have read in a very long time' pairs the superlative with the present perfect.

Q.6 · Answer (C) take the bull by the horns
The idiom is 'take the bull by the horns': to face a difficulty boldly.

Q.7 · Answer (D) dim
No comparison is being made, so the positive degree: 'in the dim light'.

Q.8 · Answer (D) Sombre
'Austere' means severely plain and serious, without comfort or luxury; of the options 'sombre' (sober and serious) comes closest, and 'luxurious' is its opposite.

Q.10 · Answer (A) bear
To 'bear with' someone is to be patient with them; 'bare', 'bar' and 'bairn' (a child) do not fit.

Q.11 · Answer (A) The sky is covering
The clouds cover the sky, so the sky takes the passive: 'The sky is covered (or is being covered) with dark clouds'.

Q.12 · Answer (C) sympathetic
'Mean' here means unkind; its opposite is 'sympathetic'. 'Rude' is close to a synonym.

Q.13 · Answer (A) dropped by the club unexpectedly
To 'drop by' a place is to pay it a short, informal visit: 'Heba dropped by the club unexpectedly'.

Q.14 · Answer (A) century
The correct spelling is 'century'.

Q.15 · Answer (C) What
'What' introduces a noun clause meaning 'the thing that': 'What we gave them was some homemade ice cream.'

Q.16 · Answer (D) The committee has careful
The verb 'considered' needs an adverb: 'The committee has carefully considered the report'.

Q.17 · Answer (B) pursuit
The correct spelling is 'pursuit'.

Q.18 · Answer (B) had wondering
'Had' cannot take the -ing form on its own: 'had been wondering' (past perfect continuous) or 'were wondering'.

Q.19 · Answer (B) Ethics
Committees that oversee how animals are treated, for example in research, are called Animal Ethics Committees.

Q.20 · Answer (D) extremely loudly
To shout 'at the top of your lungs' is to shout as loudly as you can.

Q.21 · Answer (B) facilitates
Language 'facilitates', that is makes easier, communication and interaction.

Q.22 · Answer (B) The
'The richness of language': a particular, defined quality takes the definite article.

Q.23 · Answer (B) challenging
After 'would be' the adjective 'challenging' fits: without language, cooperation would be difficult.

Q.24 · Answer (A) integrated
The passive 'are integrated' needs the past participle: new words are absorbed into the vocabulary.

Q.25 · Answer (D) In any case
'In any case' leads into the closing statement; 'in order to' needs a verb after it and 'in spite of' a noun, and 'in conclusive' is not a phrase.

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